

ICC Student Travel Grant Budget and Abstract

Instructions: Complete and submit this via email to icc-admin-l@mtu.edu when you complete your travel grant form found [here](#). Please convert this to a PDF and send with the filename "lastname-travelgrant-semester" (for example, "smith-travelgrant-summer-2024")

Name: Printed: Yaman Aljnadi
Signature: Yaman Aljnadi

Advisor(s): Printed: _____ Printed: _____
Signature: _____ Signature: _____

Requested Budget: Fill out the following information.

Transportation	\$ 190 (\$95 Per Day)
Lodging	\$ 465 (Hampton Inn Chicago Downtown/Magnificent Mile)
Meals	\$ 120 (\$60 Per Day)
Registration fees	\$ 270 (\$90 Per Individual)
Other (please specify)	\$
Total Budget	\$1045
Total Request from ICC	\$750
Source of additional funding (if applicable)	N/A

Abstract: Provide an abstract on the next page that includes, name of the conference or meeting, title of your presentation or poster, name(s) of author(s), and a presentation or poster abstract.

Abstract

MBAA International Conference 2026 **Location:** Chicago, IL **Title:** Language Model Forge: An Early-Stage Design Science Study to Simplify Language Model Customization **Authors:** Yaman Aljnadi, Cletus Ngwerume, Sibonginkosi Nkashe, Jeffrey Wall.

This study introduces "Language Model Forge," a Design Science Research (DSR) project aimed at simplifying the customization and fine-tuning of Large Language Models (LLMs) for non-specialist developers. While LLM integration is growing rapidly, the technical complexity of customization remains a significant barrier. This paper proposes an early-stage design framework and artifact to streamline these workflows. Accepted for the Society for the Advancement of Information Systems (SAIS) track, this work establishes a literature-driven foundation for simplifying AI customization. Presentation at MBAA International 2026 will provide the peer feedback necessary to validate the design and prepare the study for full-scale empirical testing and journal submission.